

KEY TOPIC 4: LIFE IN NAZI GERMANY, 1933–39

From Democracy to Dictatorship: How did Hitler destroy the Weimar Republic?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: Key Topic 4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women, 1933–1939				
L2: Key Topic 4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young, 1933–1939				
L3: Key Topic 4.3: Employment and Living Standards, 1933–1939				
L4: Key Topic 4.4: The Persecution of Minorities, 1933–1939				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: Key Topic 4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the laws and incentives used to increase the birth rate and promote traditional marriage.
- ☐ Analyse the methods used by the NS-Frauenschaft and the Deutsches Frauenwerk to control women's daily lives and education.
- ☐ Evaluate the 'great contradiction' of Nazi policy: why female employment actually increased between 1933 and 1939 despite ideological attempts to force women out of the workplace.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the name of the working-class youth opposition group that rebelled by going on hikes and wearing checked shirts?

2. What were the Sopade reports?

3. Who was the carpenter who attempted to assassinate Hitler with a bomb in 1939?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about how industrial workers carried out passive resistance in Nazi factories.

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Kinder, Küche, Kirche | Law for the Encouragement of Marriage (1933) | The Mother's Cross (Mutterkreuz) | Lebensborn (Spring of Life) | NS-Frauenschaft (NSF) | Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW) | Gertrud Scholtz-Klink

The Nazi regime firmly believed that a woman's true purpose was restricted to _____ (Children, Kitchen, Church). To boost the declining birth rate, the state passed the _____, providing loans to young couples, and proudly awarded _____ to women who had large families. SS leaders like Himmler even went further by establishing the radical _____ program to breed 'racially pure' children. To coordinate female indoctrination, the government dissolved independent women's groups and forced them to join the massive _____ and the elite _____, both overseen by the loyal Nazi leader _____.

Active Tasks

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q1. Complete these sentences based on the lesson's core narrative: 1) Nazi policies aimed to confine women to the roles of "Kinder, Küche, Kirche" BUT... 2) The Law for the Encouragement of Marriage was introduced BECAUSE... 3) The Nazis created organizations like the NS-Frauenschaft SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Using the keywords 'Kinder, Küche, Kirche', 'Law for the Encouragement of Marriage', 'The Mother's Cross', and 'Gertrud Scholtz-Klink', write a short paragraph explaining how Nazi policies aimed to shape women's lives in the 1930s.

Causal Linkage

Q3. Explain how the Nazi ideology of racial purity and the urgent need for population growth led directly to the implementation of programs like the 'Lebensborn' and the creation of 'The Mother's Cross'.

Counter-Factual History

Q4. What if the Nazi regime had not faced severe labour shortages due to rearmament? How might their policies towards women's employment have evolved differently, and what would be the long-term implications for German society?

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q61. 2. Explain why Nazi policies towards women changed between 1933 and 1939 (12 marks).

You may use the following in your answer:

- **Marriage loans**
- **Rearmament**

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):
From a speech by Gertrude Scholtz-Klink, Head of the Nazi Women's Organisation, 1934.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From a secret Social Democratic report on factory labor, Saxony, 1938.

The German woman has a glorious, sacred task in the life of the nation: the care of her husband, her home, and her family. Our mission is to be the helper and the comrade, nurturing the small world of the home so that the greater world of the state can be strong. We have proudly left the aimless office jobs to fulfill our true biological duty as mothers.

The Nazi claims that women belong in the home are a complete joke. In this industrial district, the textile and arms factories are facing a catastrophic labor shortage because of conscription and rearmament. The government is actively recruiting married women back into the workforce, offering them cash incentives. Many women are working twelve-hour shifts while their children are neglected.

Interpretation 1 (The Ideological Success View):

Nazi policies towards women successfully realized their domestic and racial ideals. Through marriage loans, financial child-subsidies, and the Mother's Cross medal, the state successfully encouraged women to focus entirely on motherhood and raise the national birth rate. Out of national pride and economic comfort, the majority of women conformed willingly, returning to traditional domestic roles.

Interpretation 2 (The Economic Pragmatism View):

Nazi policies towards women were an ideological failure that collapsed under economic necessity. While the regime wanted women to remain in the home, the demands of secret rearmament and conscription from 1936 onwards created severe labor shortages. The state had to completely abandon its domestic ideal, pulling millions of women back into grueling industrial and agricultural work.

Exam Q62. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into Nazi policies towards women? (8 marks)

Exam Q63. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about Nazi policies towards women. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

Exam Q64. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about Nazi policies towards women. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

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General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: Key Topic 4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of how the school curriculum and teaching profession were completely 'Nazified' by Bernhard Rust.
- ☐ Analyse the differences between the youth movements for boys (military preparation) and girls (domestic preparation).
- ☐ Evaluate the extent to which Nazi youth policies were a success, acknowledging the Grade 9 nuance that resistance did exist.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the name of the 1933 law that gave couples 1,000 marks to marry, provided the wife left her job?

2. What three words (beginning with K) summarised the traditional Nazi ideal for women?

3. Who was the Reich Women's Leader in charge of the Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW)?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about how the Edelweiss Pirates opposed the Nazis.

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Indoctrination | National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB) | Bernhard Rust | Eugenics (Race Studies) | Hitlerjugend (HJ) | Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) | Faith and Beauty Society

Your Sentence:

Active Tasks

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q1. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson: 1) The Nazi regime introduced significant changes to the school curriculum BUT... 2) Membership in the Hitlerjugend

(HJ) and Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) became compulsory BECAUSE... 3) Teachers faced pressure to join the NSLB and swear loyalty to Hitler, SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Explain how the following keywords relate to Nazi policies towards the young, using specific examples from the lesson narrative: Indoctrination, National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB), Eugenics (Race Studies), Hitlerjugend (HJ), Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM).

Causal Linkage

Q3. How did the Nazi regime's control over the education system and its establishment of compulsory youth organizations (HJ and BDM) *together* serve to consolidate their power and prepare Germany for its long-term goals by 1939?

The 'What If' Challenge

Q4. What if the Nazi regime had **failed to gain significant control over the education system and youth organizations by 1939? How might this have impacted their ability to consolidate power, prepare for war, and maintain public support in the long term?**

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q66. 2. Explain why Nazi policies towards the young were implemented, 1933–1939. (12 marks).

You may use the following in your answer:

- **The Hitler Youth**
- **Education**

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):
From a letter written by a 15-year-old boy
in a Hitler Youth camp, 1936.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From a secret report by the Social Democratic Party in exile (SOPADE), 1938.

We practically do not have a single minute of the day to ourselves in this camp. This is not camp life; it is military barrack life. Grueling military drill and exercises in the mud start right after a meager breakfast, and we have no athletics at all. We perform these exercises until our tongues hang out of our mouths, and we have only one wish: to sleep.

Enthusiasm for the Hitler Youth is declining rapidly. Now that membership has been made compulsory, the teenagers view the meetings as a boring chore rather than an exciting adventure. The boys are highly rebellious against the constant marching, and usually only a third of the group appears for roll-call. Many parents are secretly supporting their children's truancy to protect them from this mind-numbing militarism.

Interpretation 1 (The Complete Indoctrination View):

The Nazi regime was highly successful in achieving its primary aim of controlling and brainwashing the minds of the younger generation. By completely Nazifying the school curriculum, rewriting textbooks, and coordinating all leisure time through the Hitler Youth and BDM, they successfully isolated children from traditional family influences. This produced a generation of fanatically loyal supporters who genuinely idolized the Führer.

Interpretation 2 (The Absenteeism and Rebellion View):

The Nazification of German youth was only a superficial success that masked growing boredom, resentment, and active rebellion. Compulsory membership laws in 1936 alienated millions of teenagers as exciting camping trips were replaced by repetitive, grueling military drill. This led to massive absenteeism and the rapid growth of rebellious youth sub-cultures, like the Edelweiss Pirates, who actively rejected Nazi discipline.

Exam Q67. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into Nazi policies towards the young? (8 marks)

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Exam Q68. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about Nazi policies towards the young. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

Exam Q69. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about Nazi policies towards the young. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

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General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: Key Topic 4.3: Employment and Living Standards, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the government schemes used to reduce unemployment (RAD, public works, and rearmament).
- ☐ Analyse the shift in economic leadership from Schacht's 'New Plan' to Goering's 'Four Year Plan' and the goal of Autarky.
- ☐ Evaluate the extent to which the Nazi economic recovery was a statistical illusion (invisible unemployment) and assess the true impact on living standards.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the name of the society created in 1938 for young women aged 17–21?

2. What was the legal quota cap placed on female university enrolment?

3. Name the compulsory union that 97% of teachers had joined by 1939.

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop about why Nazi policies towards female employment contradicted their own ideological goals.

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Invisible Unemployment**

Active Tasks

True/False/Justify

Q1. Read the following statements. For each, state whether it is True or False, and then justify your answer using specific evidence from the lesson narrative.

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how the Nazi regime managed both employment figures and public perception of living standards between 1933 and 1939. You must accurately use at least FIVE of the following keywords: Invisible Unemployment, Autarky, Ersatz, Hermann Goering, National Labour Service (RAD), German Labour Front (DAF), Strength Through Joy (KdF), Beauty of Labour (SdA). Underline or bold the keywords you use.

Causal Linkage

Q3. Explain the complex relationship between the Nazi regime's rearmament goals, the official reduction in unemployment, and the actual living standards of ordinary Germans between 1933 and 1939. Your answer should clearly demonstrate how these three elements were interconnected and influenced each other.

Counter-Factual History

Q4. Imagine a scenario where, from 1933, the Nazi regime had genuinely prioritized improving the living standards of ordinary Germans through increased consumer goods production, higher real wages, and less emphasis on rearmament and autarky. How might this alternative economic strategy have impacted:

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q71. 2. Explain why employment and living standards changed in Nazi Germany between 1933 and 1939 (12 marks).

You may use the following in your answer:

- **Strength through Joy (KdF)**
- **rearmament**

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B: From a letter written by a German factory worker, 1937.

Through the Strength through Joy (KdF) scheme, our lives have genuinely improved. We are able to

Source C: From a report compiled by an undercover agent of the Social Democratic Party in exile (SOPADE),

go on cheap weekly theater trips and even subsidized holidays that were completely beyond our reach before. There is a real sense of comradeship, and we feel that the government genuinely values our hard work.

describing attitudes in a Berlin factory, 1938.

The workers are deeply unhappy. It is true that everyone has a job, but their wages are frozen and the price of food has risen significantly. They are forced to work longer hours under compulsory service, and heavy deductions are taken directly from their pay. The KdF trips are viewed as a propaganda circus that only a few highly paid party favorites can actually afford.

Interpretation 1: The "Better Off" View

The standard of living for German workers improved under the Nazi regime, helping to secure their loyalty. Full employment, stable prices, and popular state-run welfare and leisure programs like Strength through Joy (KdF) provided ordinary families with holidays, sports, and canteens they could never have accessed before. This material progress made many workers genuinely grateful to the regime.

Interpretation 2: The Exploitation View

The apparent improvement in workers' living standards was a propaganda illusion that masked severe economic exploitation. Workers lost their independent trade unions, the right to strike, and their political voice. Real wages fell due to inflation, working hours increased significantly, and schemes like the Volkswagen savings program were outright con tricks designed to fund secret rearmament.

Exam Q72. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into employment and living standards in Nazi Germany between 1933 and 1939? (8 marks)

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Exam Q73. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about employment and living standards in Nazi Germany between 1933 and 1939. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

Exam Q74. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about employment and living standards in Nazi Germany between 1933 and 1939. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

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General Notes

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Teacher Comment:

L4: Key Topic 4.4: The Persecution of Minorities, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of Nazi racial ideology, distinguishing between 'Untermenschen' and 'Asocials'.
- ☐ Analyse the escalating stages of anti-Semitic persecution: from early boycotts (1933) to legislation (1935), bureaucratic dehumanisation (1938), and state-sponsored violence.
- ☐ Evaluate the brutal methods used against the disabled, Roma/Sinti, and homosexuals, including the Marzahn camp, sterilisation, and the T4 programme.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the name of the 'substitute' goods the Nazis developed to avoid relying on imports?

2. Who took over the Nazi economy in 1936 with the 'Four Year Plan'?

3. What percentage of the school timetable was given to PE to prepare students for war and motherhood?

4. 15 Second Challenge: Try to speak for 15 seconds non-stop explaining exactly how the Nazis created 'Invisible Unemployment'.

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Volksgemeinschaft | Social Darwinism | Untermenschen | Asocials | Anti-Semitism | Eugenics | Aryanism

The Nazi regime envisioned a racially pure _____ (People's Community) built entirely upon the pseudo-scientific principles of _____ and _____. Anyone who did not fit this ideal, including the disabled, homosexuals, and vagrants, were branded as _____ and subjected to forced sterilization or imprisonment. However, the most extreme persecution was driven by virulent _____, as the Nazis targeted Jews as subhuman _____, systematically stripping their wealth and businesses through a process of forced _____.

Active Tasks

True/False/Justify

Q1. Read the following statements. For each, state whether it is True or False, and then justify your answer using specific information from the lesson narrative.

Vocabulary in Context

Q2. Using at least THREE of the keywords (Volksgemeinschaft, Social Darwinism, Untermenschen, Asocials, Anti-Semitism, Eugenics, Aryanisation), explain how the Nazi regime justified and implemented its persecution of *Jewish people* between 1933 and 1939.

Causal Linkage

Q3. Explain the causal link between core Nazi ideological concepts (such as 'Social Darwinism' and the idea of 'Untermenschen') and the specific policies of persecution enacted against *both* disabled individuals and Roma/Sinti people between 1933 and 1939.

Complex Causal Reasoning

Q4. To what extent was the persecution of *all* minority groups (Jews, Roma/Sinti, disabled, homosexuals, and 'asocials') between 1933 and 1939 driven by a single, overarching Nazi goal, or were there distinct, separate motivations for persecuting each group? Justify your answer with specific evidence from the lesson.

GCSE Exam Practice

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

Exam Q76. 2. Explain why the Nazis persecuted minorities in Germany between 1933 and 1939 (12 marks).

You may use the following in your answer:

- **Nazi ideology**
- **Consolidation of power**

You must also use information of your own.

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):
From a diary entry of a Berlin citizen, 10 November 1938.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source): From an eyewitness report by a British diplomat stationed in Leipzig, November 1938.

Walking through the city today was horrifying. The shattered glass storefronts of Jewish-owned businesses lined the streets, with crude anti-Semitic insults painted across the bricks. The police stood by doing absolutely nothing. Uniformed SA men stood laughing next to destroyed properties, while a silent crowd of ordinary citizens watched the devastation from a distance with looks of shock and absolute terror.

The destruction of the synagogues and shops was executed with military precision. The perpetrators did not appear to be angry local citizens, but rather organized groups of SA men in civilian clothes who arrived in trucks carrying hammers and incendiary devices. The local police stood by and did nothing to interfere, having received strict orders from the Ministry of the Interior to let the violence proceed.

Interpretation 1 (The Planned State Pogrom View):

The anti-Semitic violence of Kristallnacht was a highly coordinated, systematic operation planned and executed entirely from above by Joseph Goebbels and the paramilitary SA, aiming to force Jewish families into absolute economic and physical isolation.

Interpretation 2 (The Public Fear/Isolation View):

While the state-controlled press portrayed the violence of Kristallnacht as a spontaneous outburst of public anger, many ordinary Germans watched the destruction with deep alarm, concern, and disapproval. However, they remained completely silent and conformed to the regime's actions solely out of terror of the Gestapo and fear of immediate arrest.

Exam Q77. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the events of Kristallnacht? (8 marks)

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Exam Q78. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the events of Kristallnacht. What is the main difference between these views? (4 marks)

Exam Q79. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the events of Kristallnacht. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4 marks)

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

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General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

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